

Cumulative Final Drill Pack

EAM310 · East Asian Medicine Diagnosis I · VUIM Summer 2026

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Active-Recall Short Answer · Weeks 1–9

TCM for Ballroom Dancers

reMarkable Edition

How to use this drill pack: Cover the Answer Key section (last 2 pages) and write your answer in the blank before checking. Active recall (retrieving the answer yourself) builds retention far better than re-reading — this is the step that comes after your first Study Guide pass. Do a full pass, mark what you missed, then redo only those the next day. Week 5 is intentionally absent (midterm week, no new content).

1 • Week 1 — Vital Substances

1. What is the difference between Pre-Heaven and Post-Heaven Essence?

2. Name the six functions of Qi.

3. A patient presents with distension that's worse than the pain itself, moving pain, and a Wiry pulse. Qi Stagnation or Blood Stasis?

4. What are the four Qi pathology patterns?

5. Which organ is the main source of Blood formation?

6. A tongue is purple with a bluish tint. What does bluish (vs. reddish) purple indicate about the cause?

7. What is the difference between Jīn and Yè?

8. Pitting edema starting in the face and hands, spreading down — which organ's Yang deficiency?

9. Name the Five Spirits (Wu Shen) and their associated organs.

10. What is False Shen, and why is it dangerous to mistake for recovery?

11. Non-substantial Phlegm misting the Heart orifice causes what category of symptom?

12. Complete the relationship: Qi is the ___ of Blood; Blood is the ___ of Qi.

2 • Week 2 — Eight Principles

1. What is the single differentiator between Excess pain and Deficiency pain?

2. A patient has fever with NO aversion to cold. Exterior or Interior?

3. Full Heat has a whole-face redness; Empty Heat has redness limited to where?

4. What is the key difference between Full-Cold and Empty-Cold on pulse?

5. In False Heat/True Cold, what does the patient's thirst pattern look like?

6. Name the four Collapse of Yang signs.

7. Name the four Collapse of Yin signs.

8. A patient's tongue is red and dry with no coating, and they have night sweats and five-palm heat. Which pattern?

9. What stage/pattern is characterized by alternating cold and heat sensations?

10. Deductive vs. inductive vs. analogical reasoning — give one example of each from 8 Principles.

3 • Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis

1. What organs are found at the Right Chǐ position?

2. What are the three components of a normal pulse (胃神根)?

3. Name the seasonal pulse for each season.

4. Why is a Floating pulse not automatically diagnostic of an Exterior pattern?

5. What's the difference between Knotted, Hasty, and Intermittent pulses?

6. A pulse feels like "a guitar string about to snap." Name the quality and its main indication.

7. A pulse feels like "a pearl rolling on a plate." Name the quality and its main indication.

8. What does a Choppy pulse indicate, and what does it physically feel like?

9. Floating + Tight = ? Deep + Rapid = ? Rapid + Wiry = ?

10. Which pulse quality is considered the one qualitatively "normal" entry among the 28, and why is it easy to misdiagnose?

11. What is the Bin Hu Mai Xue system's version of the Right Chǐ position, and how does it differ from the Nan Jing?

4 • Week 4 — Tongue Diagnosis

1. What does the tongue coating primarily reflect (which organ system)?

2. Antibiotics cause what change to the tongue coating?

3. A tongue is red with no coating. Full Heat or Empty Heat?

4. Purple tongue always indicates what pathology, regardless of shade?

5. What's the difference in meaning between a Heart crack and a Stomach crack on the tongue?

6. Rootless coating indicates deficiency of which organ's Qi/Yin?

7. A tongue is pale, swollen, and wet. What pattern?

8. Tooth-marked (scalloped) tongue edges indicate what pattern?

9. What do distended, dark sublingual veins indicate, and in which Burner?

10. A patient's tongue has no coating anywhere and the body is red. Which organ's Yin deficiency?

11. Name three tongue findings that would suggest Liver-Blood Deficiency specifically.

5 • Week 6 — Diagnosis by Observation

1. What are the three signs of "Having Shen" in the eyes vs. "Loss of Shen"?

2. On the Su Wen 32 face map, which cheek corresponds to the Liver — the patient's left or right?

3. Name the Five Wheels of the Eye and their organs.

4. A patient's face is bright red over the entire face vs. red only on the cheeks (malar). What's the difference in pattern?

5. Yellow eyes, bright like a tangerine peel, with thirst and a sticky taste — which pattern?

6. What does a scalloped/tooth-marked tongue combined with a swollen body generally indicate about the Spleen?

7. Cold hands and feet with a warm torso — what does this suggest, and why isn't it simply "a Cold pattern"?

8. What is the difference between Wandering, Painful, Fixed, and Heat Bi Syndrome?

9. A patient's nails turn white on pressure and the color returns slowly. What does this indicate?

10. Pitting vs. non-pitting edema — which points to Yang Deficiency and which to Qi Stagnation/Dampness?

6 • Week 7 — Diagnosis by Inquiry

1. What is Schrier's "Golden Rule" for asking the 16 Questions?

2. Full pain vs. Empty pain — what's the single biggest differentiator in how pressure affects it?

3. A headache at the temples radiating to the sides of the head — which channel and likely cause?

4. A patient can't fall asleep and stay asleep, versus a patient who sleeps restlessly with vivid dreams and feels hot. Which is Empty and which is Full?

5. Desire for cold drinks vs. no thirst at all — what do these indicate?

6. Night sweats vs. daytime spontaneous sweating — which points to Yin deficiency and which to Yang deficiency?

7. A patient's menstrual blood is purple/blackish with clots. What pattern?

8. Tinnitus that's sudden, loud, and worse with pressure on the ear — Full or Empty, and what's the likely cause?

9. What are the three root mechanisms behind any bleeding presentation?

10. A child has disturbed sleep and crying as a baby — what's the likely cause?

7 • Week 8 — Diagnosis by Palpation

1. Name the three palpation techniques and what each one checks for.

2. Skin that's hot on first touch but cools when pressure is sustained — what pattern?

3. Hot on the dorsal (back) of the hand vs. hot on the palm — which is Full Heat and which is Empty Heat?

4. On the Nan Jing Five-Phase abdominal map, what organ corresponds to the area at the navel?

5. What does a "large but empty" Xu Li (apical) pulse indicate?

6. Front-Mu points are generally better for treating which condition — Excess or Deficiency?

7. A palpated nodule is soft and squishy vs. hard like a stale gummy bear — what's the difference in pathology?

8. What does dry, scaly skin on palpation suggest?

8 • Week 9 — Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling

1. Which organ governs the volume of the voice, and which governs its production?

2. Sudden loss of voice vs. gradual loss of voice — what are the causes?

3. Match the Five Element sounds to their elements: Shouting, Laughing, Singing, Weeping, Groaning.

4. A hiccup is loud vs. quiet and low — which is Full and which is Empty, and what's the typical cause of the Full type?

5. What's the difference between vomiting, belching, and hiccup in terms of underlying mechanism?

6. Strong, foul breath odor generally indicates what pattern?

7. Fishy-smelling vaginal discharge vs. strong/leathery-smelling discharge — which is Damp-Cold and which is Damp-Heat?

8. What character is used on the "Scorched" odor slide, and what's the classical character it should be?

9. Putrid-smelling sweat can indicate disease of which three organs?

Answer Key — Weeks 1–4

Week 1 — Vital Substances

#	Answer
1	Pre-Heaven: fixed at conception, from parents, stored in Kidney, cannot be replenished. Post-Heaven: extracted from food/fluids by Spleen-Stomach after birth, continuously replenishes Kidney Essence.
2	Transporting, Warming, Protecting, Holding, Transforming, Rising.
3	Qi Stagnation (distension > pain, moving, is the Qi-Stagnation signature; Blood Stasis would be more pain than distension, fixed).
4	Deficiency, Sinking, Stagnation, Rebellious Qi.

5	Spleen (generates Blood from Food Qi); Heart transforms it, Kidney contributes via Marrow.
6	Bluish-purple = stasis caused by Cold. (Reddish-purple = stasis caused by Heat.)
7	Jīn = Yang, clear/light/thin, circulates with Wei Qi on the Exterior, moves quickly. Yè = Yin, heavy/dense/turbid, circulates with Ying Qi in the Interior, moves slowly.
8	Lung Yang deficiency.
9	Heart=Shén, Liver=Hún, Lung=Pò, Spleen=Yì, Kidney=Zhì.
10	A sudden brightening/alertness in a critically ill patient right before death — the fire flaring once before going out, not genuine improvement.
11	Mental illness / disturbance of consciousness.
12	Commander; mother.

Week 2 — Eight Principles

#	Answer
1	Pressure: Deficiency pain is RELIEVED by pressure; Excess pain is AGGRAVATED by pressure.
2	Interior — the pathogen has moved past the Exterior stage once aversion to cold disappears.
3	The malar area (cheekbones) only, with a pale face beneath.
4	Full-Cold: Full/Tight/Deep pulse. Empty-Cold: Weak/Slow/Deep pulse.
5	Thirst but no desire to drink, or desire for warm fluids in small sips, despite feeling hot.
6	Chilliness, cold limbs, weak breathing, profuse oily sweating, incontinence/loose stools, Minute-Deep pulse.
7	Abundant sweating, hot skin/limbs, dry mouth desiring cold sips, constipation, retention of urine, Floating-Empty-Rapid pulse.
8	Empty-Heat from Yin Deficiency.
9	Shao Yang stage (half-Exterior, half-Interior).
10	Deductive: symptom cluster → pattern. Inductive: typical-case generalization (Floating pulse usually = Exterior). Analogical: known mechanism relationships (Heat generates Wind over time).

Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis

#	Answer
1	Pericardium / San Jiao (Nan Jing system).
2	Wèi (Stomach-Qi, gentle/flowing), Shén (Spirit, strong/rhythmic), Gēn (Root, felt deep at Chǐ).
3	Spring=Wiry, Summer=Flooding, Autumn=Hair-like, Winter=Stone.
4	Floating also occurs in Yin Deficiency (with Thin+Rapid, night sweats, five-palm heat) — true Exterior Floating requires simultaneous aversion to cold + fever.
5	Knotted=Slow+random stops (Cold/Heart-Yang def). Hasty=Rapid+random stops (Heat/Heart-Fire). Intermittent=pauses at regular intervals (most serious).
6	Wiry — Liver disharmony, Pain, Phlegm.
7	Slippery — Phlegm, Dampness, food retention, or pregnancy.
8	Blood Deficiency / exhaustion of Body Fluids; feels like scraping bamboo with a knife.
9	Wind-Cold; Interior Heat; Liver Fire.
10	Huǎn (Slowed-Down/Moderate) — easy to misread as Slow since it's 4 beats/breath, only slightly faster.
11	Kidney/Ming Men directly (not Pericardium/San Jiao) — a simpler Zang-only mapping without paired Fu organs.

Week 4 — Tongue Diagnosis

#	Answer
1	The Yang organs (particularly Stomach; Kidney also contributes).
2	Peeled patches (appearing within days, resolving ~2 weeks after stopping).
3	Empty Heat.
4	Blood Stasis, always — shade (reddish/bluish) indicates Heat vs. Cold as the cause.

5	Heart crack = constitutional tendency toward Heart patterns/emotional stress. Stomach crack (central, wide) = Stomach Yin Deficiency.
6	Stomach Qi/Yin Deficiency.
7	Yang Deficiency.
8	Spleen Qi Deficiency.
9	Blood Stasis, in the Upper Burner.
10	Kidney Yin Deficiency.
11	Pale sides of the tongue, dry eyes, scanty periods, poor sleep (Blood not anchoring the Hun).

Answer Key — Weeks 6–9

Week 6 — Diagnosis by Observation

#	Answer
1	Having Shen: alert, bright, twinkling eyes. Loss of Shen: dull, blurred, lifeless eyes.
2	The patient's LEFT cheek (a common quiz trap since it's the practitioner's right when facing them).
3	Blood=Heart (canthus), Qi=Lung (sclera), Wind=Liver (iris), Water=Kidney (pupil), Flesh=Spleen (eyelids).
4	Whole face red = Full/Excess Heat. Malar only = Empty/Deficient Heat.
5	Damp-Heat with Heat predominant.
6	Spleen Qi Deficiency — the Spleen can't transform/transport, so fluid accumulates and the tongue bloats against the teeth.
7	Liver-Qi Stagnation — the Liver isn't ensuring smooth Qi flow to the extremities even though heat is trapped centrally.
8	Wandering=Wind (moves joint to joint). Painful=Cold (severe, fixed). Fixed=Damp (soreness/heaviness). Heat=Heat (sudden swelling/redness).
9	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood.
10	Pitting = Yang Deficiency. Non-pitting = Qi Stagnation or Dampness.

Week 7 — Diagnosis by Inquiry

#	Answer
1	Every question should confirm or exclude a pattern — never recite the 16 as a rote script.
2	Full pain is aggravated by pressure; Empty pain is relieved by pressure.
3	Shao Yang channel — Exterior Wind or Liver/Gallbladder Fire rising.
4	Can't fall/stay asleep = Empty (Blood deficiency not anchoring Shen/Hun). Restless + dreaming + heat = Full (pathogens agitating Shen/Hun).
5	Desire for cold drinks = Heat. No thirst at all = Cold, or no Heat present.
6	Night sweats = Yin deficiency. Daytime spontaneous sweating = Yang deficiency.
7	Blood or Cold stasis.
8	Full — Liver-Fire, Liver-Yang rising, or Liver-Wind.
9	Excess Heat pushing Blood out; tension/pressure forcing it out; Deficiency failing to hold it in.
10	Retention of food or Stomach-Heat.

Week 8 — Diagnosis by Palpation

#	Answer
1	Palpation (tracing channels for structural changes), Pressing (thumb/fingertip for tenderness), Feeling (temperature/moisture/texture).
2	Exterior Wind-Heat, still at the Wei (exterior) level.
3	Dorsal (back of hand) = Full Heat. Palm = Empty Heat.
4	Spleen/Earth.
5	Heart-Qi deficiency.
6	Deficiency (though also used to clear Excess).
7	Soft/squishy = Phlegm (fresher, more moist). Hard/stale = Blood Stasis or Cold congealing.

8	Exhaustion of Body Fluids or severe Liver-Blood Deficiency.
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Week 9 — Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling

#	Answer
1	Kidney = volume. Lung = production.
2	Sudden = invasion of Wind-Heat. Gradual = Lung-Qi or Lung-Yin deficiency.
3	Shouting=Wood, Laughing=Fire, Singing=Earth, Weeping=Metal, Groaning=Water.
4	Loud = Full, often Liver-Qi invading Stomach. Quiet/low = Empty, often Stomach-Qi/Yin deficiency.
5	All three are Rebellious Stomach-Qi: vomiting = food/fluid/sputum flows up and out with sound; belching = air/gas flows up making sound in the throat; hiccup = involuntary diaphragm spasm from the rebellion.
6	Stomach Heat or retention of food.
7	Fishy = Damp-Cold. Strong/leathery = Damp-Heat.
8	Slide uses 笑 (xiào); classical character is 焦 (jiāo). Flagged, not yet confirmed with Prof. Schrier.
9	Lungs, Liver, or Kidneys.